

U.S. Software

Another Security VaR Call: 2Q Data Points on Firewall, SASE, Data, Endpoint, Identity, & VM

We hosted a call with a security VaR and came away with details on its 2Q performance of several specific vendors across network security (PANW, FTNT, CHKP), zero trust (ZS), data security (VRNS, RBRK), endpoint (CRWD, S), identity (OKTA), VM (TENB, RPD), and CDN (NET). More on each below...

We hosted a call with a value-added reseller (VaR) in cybersecurity and had several vendor-specific takeaways: (1) in network security, PANW was up 45% in calendar 2Q with particular outperformance in May and June, FTNT is a smaller business but was up nicely in 2Q with a healthy pipeline, and CHKP was down y/y in 2Q; (2) in zero trust/SASE, ZS was flat q/q in calendar 2Q and this partner saw strength in new logos and some mid-market wins; (3) in endpoint, CRWD is this partner's largest business and was up 50%+ y/y in C2Q off of broad based strength across the platform, and it sounds like this VaR could see 30% y/y growth in its CY26 CRWD business, while S was down ~30% y/y and it sounded like there was some competitive noise; (4) in identity, this partner's OKTA business was down ~15% y/y following strong 1Q, but noted that this quarter had a tough comp; (5) in data security, VRNS was up ~60% y/y in 2Q as data security is becoming a higher priority, while RBRK is a smaller business but showed solid growth y/y with good demand for security and identity; (6) in VM, this VaR's smaller QLYS business doubled y/y, TENB was up 40% y/y, and RPD was down 15% y/y; (7) this VaR's NET business was up 57% y/y and is seeing success in areas of cybersecurity outside of Act 1 products.

- **Overall security business is over \$2B in annual revenue and grew 30% in Q2; Mythos/Glasswing driving more demand and budget reallocations toward security.** This organization is a large cybersecurity-focused value-added reseller (VaR), with a focus on US enterprise clients across multiple verticals including healthcare, finance, manufacturing, and retail among others, with an overall security business that was over \$2B in size last year. In Q2, this VaR's security business grew 30% y/y which also equates to 53% for 1H 2026 as a whole, and it sounds like this was trending at or above plan for 2026 overall with some vendors outperforming this mark and some underperforming (more on each vendor below). Recall Anthropic's Mythos model and its partnership with security vendors under Project Glasswing both started making headlines in early April – this VaR has seen more demand for security tools in the weeks/months that followed as buyers are dedicating

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Industry Update

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incremental budget toward cyber and (in some cases) shifting budget away from other areas like laptop, router, or switch refreshes to better protect against elevated cyber risks.

- **For network security: (1) PANW was up 45% in calendar 2Q with particular strength in May and June; (2) FTNT is a smaller business but saw strong growth in 2Q - this partner saw some customers pull forward demand ahead of price increases, but pipeline isn't showing any signs of slowing down; (3) CHKP was down y/y in 2Q.** PANW is the second largest partner for this VaR with over a hundred million in annual revenue, and its PANW business was up 45% y/y in calendar 2Q with particular strength in May and June as sales reps are closing deals ahead of the fiscal year end in July. Zooming in, areas like SASE, XSIAM, and Prisma AIRS are driving this outperformance, and this VaR is also seeing strength in its CyberArk business. FTNT is a smaller vendor for this VaR and saw healthy growth y/y in 2Q, though off a relatively small base and some of the outperformance this quarter may have come from share shift to this partner. That said, this partner saw strong growth in the quarter from a same store sales perspective, and noted particular strength in OT and areas of the platform outside of firewall like cloud security and security operations. Separately, this VaR did see some customers pull forward purchases planned for later in 2026 to get ahead of price increases, particularly in February, March, and April, but its pipeline looks strong in 2H as it isn't seeing signs of slowdown in firewall and it expects healthy growth in areas outside of firewall like SASE and OT. On CHKP, this partner does tens of millions in annual revenue and its CHKP business was down 10% in 2Q. It noted recent go-to-market changes but hasn't seen the benefits from those changes come to fruition yet in the field.
- **For zero trust/SASE: ZS was flat q/q in calendar 2Q with success in new logo business, selling areas outside of core ZIA/ZPA, and some mid-market wins.** This partner does around a hundred million in annual revenue with ZS, and its business was flat sequentially, and grew ~5% y/y in calendar 2Q after growing 70% y/y in 1Q. Zooming in, this VaR is seeing success selling other areas of the platform outside of ZIA and ZPA, and is also seeing more wins in the mid-market in addition to the typical large enterprise wins. This partner noted that the zero trust/SASE market is getting more crowded as other vendors have entered the space, but it has seen recent strength in new logo business for ZS.
- **For endpoint: (1) CRWD is this partner's largest business and is up ~50%+ y/y in C2Q - sounds like broad-based strength across the platform and could see 30% y/y growth for the full-year; (2) S business was down ~30% y/y following strong 1Q, with partner noting some competitive noise.** CrowdStrike, which is this VaR's largest business at several hundred million, posted strong 50%+ y/y growth in C2Q, accelerating from mid-HSD y/y growth in 1Q. This VaR continues to see NG-SIEM as the most popular module outside of endpoint, which we believe could be driven by customers move off from legacy providers such as Splunk (acquired by CSCO, covered by Tim Long). Looking out, it sounds like pipeline is strong with broad based strength across the platform, and this VaR believes that its CRWD business could finish CY26 at 30% y/y growth. SentinelOne, which is a smaller business at several tens of millions, was down ~30% y/y following a strong 1Q, also calling out some competitive displacements of S customers moving to CRWD.
- **For identity security: OKTA was down ~15% y/y with some slipped deals and competitive losses, but this VaR highlighted that strength in 2Q last year also created a tough comp and OKTA is well positioned with new AI security products and partner-first strategy.** This VaR's OKTA business is in the tens of millions and saw ~15% y/y decline for 2Q following a strong 1Q, with the caveat that outperformance in 2Q last year created a tough comp. This partner attributed some of the softness in the quarter to a couple deals that slipped to 3Q, as well as some competitive losses to MSFT (covered by Raimo Lenschow). Separately, this VaR noted that OKTA is well positioned with new AI security products, Okta for AI Agents (GA'd

Apr. 2026) and Auth0 for AI Agents (GA'd Nov. 2025) and highlighted that OKTA has been deepening their relationship with the channel and is taking a more partner-first strategy, citing conversations that there will not be any net new OKTA business that goes direct.

- **For data security: (1) VRNS was up ~60% y/y in 2Q as data security is more of a priority which creates a rising tide for VRNS and a private DSPM competitor; (2) RBRK is a smaller business for this VaR, but grew nicely y/y with good demand for security and identity resilience.** This partner does tens of millions in annual revenue with VRNS, and its business was up ~60% y/y in 2Q, which was well above plan and reflected strength across both new logo and expansion business. This VaR also saw healthy performance for a private DSPM competitor in the quarter, and sees the data security market as a two horse race between VRNS and this private competitor. Stepping back, this VaR is seeing enterprises prioritize data security more, particularly as data governance and AI governance go hand in hand, which is creating a rising tide market that Varonis and its private DSPM competitor are both benefiting from. This VaR also has a RBRK business that is smaller today in the single-digit millions range as this partnership is still in its early days – this VaR saw 26% growth in their RBRK business in calendar Q2 with strong demand albeit on a small revenue base. RBRK continues to have strong messaging around prioritizing cybersecurity use cases vs traditional backup, and newer areas like identity resilience continue to gain good traction among customers.
- **For vulnerability management: (1) smaller QLYS business doubled y/y, TENB grew 40% y/y, and RPD was down 15% y/y; (2) customers view QLYS as stronger in patching and compliance, while TENB excels in scanning and IoT/OT environments; (3) some competitive noise for RPD.** VM seemed stronger this quarter for this VaR – Qualys (not covered) is a couple tens of million business and is up 100% y/y in 2Q. TENB and RPD businesses are approximately twice the size vs QLYS, and TENB is up 40% y/y while RPD is down 15% y/y in 2Q. VM has become more topical this quarter, and this partner noted that customers tend to like QLYS for patch management integration and compliance, while customers point to TENB's strength in scanning, IoT/OT environments, and Tenable One dashboard for additional security capabilities. On RPD, it sounds like this partner sees some competitive noise with a customer moving away from RPD's VM and SIEM to CRWD's NG SIEM and exposure management, which is similar to what we heard last quarter from this VaR.
- **For other security: NET grew 57% y/y and this VaR highlighted that NET is becoming more competitive in other areas of cybersecurity beyond traditional CDN and they have seen minimal impact from recent RIF.** This VaR's NET business is in the tens of millions and saw 57% y/y growth, continuing momentum from a strong 1Q. This partner noted that while NET is known for its Act 1 products (CDN, DDoS, WAF), they are seeing NET becoming more competitive in other areas of cybersecurity like SASE and bot management. Separately, this VaR has seen minimal impact from NET's 20% RIF in 1Q, noting that there have been some back office delays in getting quotes turned around and launching POVs, but from a product and support standpoint, customers are happy.

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Fortinet, Inc. (FTNT, 09-Jul-2026, USD 163.73), Equal Weight/Positive, CD/CE/J

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Rapid7 (RPD, 09-Jul-2026, USD 11.41), Underweight/Positive, CE/FA/J

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